THUSHARA VARGHESE

PRODUCT DESIGNER

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SUMMARY

Psychology-trained product designer turning complex AI workflows into simple, polished interfaces. ~3 years in product design, the last 2.5 as the sole designer at an AI-native B2B SaaS startup.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

B.A. (Honours) Psychology
IGNOU · 2020 – 2023 · Grade: 8
Coursework in cognitive psychology, data analysis, and research methods. Conducted quantitative study on personality traits and eating attitudes with implications for health.

Human-Computer Interaction
Georgia Tech via edX · 2023 – 2024
Master's-level credited course (CS6750) covering design principles, cognition, culture, ethics, prototyping, evaluation, and agile methods.

Google UX Design Certification
Coursera · 2023 – 2024
Completed 200+ hours of training and three peer-reviewed projects, developing skills in UX, UI, and interaction design.

IBM Design Thinking Practitioner
IBM · Feb 2025

SKILLS

Research: User Interviews · Usability Testing · Heuristic Evaluation · Competitive Audits · Analytics (GA4, Clarity) · Mixed-Methods UXR

Design: Figma · Component-Based Design Systems · User Flows · Wireframing · High-Fidelity UI · Interactive Prototyping · Interaction & Motion · Typography & Hierarchy · Edge & Empty States · Responsive Web · Data-Heavy Dashboards · Accessibility · Claude Code & Cursor

AI: Evaluation & QA Workflows · Explainable AI UX

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer · Gistly.ai
May 2024 – Present · AI quality assurance platform
- First and only designer hired; designed 120+ screens, 20+ end-to-end flows, and a ~50-component design system
- Cut rubric build time 24% in internal benchmarks with a new AI scoring template builder used by 6+ companies
- Designed and built a Review/Test/Versions workflow using coding agents, enabling QA analysts to verify and refine AI scores
- Redesigned and shipped the Records table for complex B2B data; Records reach rose 74% (5.3% to 9.3%)
- Redesigned the marketing site; engagement time up 47% and homepage clicks up 80% year-over-year

UX/UI Designer · Paper Toy Studio
Nov 2023 – Apr 2024
- Ran foundational research for a young-adult social app, then took concepts from wireframes to hi-fi UI
- Designed gamification mechanics, grounded in game theory, to encourage engagement

Designer & Illustrator · Freelance
2020 – 2025
- Logos, illustration, and brand design for international clients on Etsy and Fiverr
- Illustrated a 38-page children's book, sold at Waterstones

PROJECTS

Kite AI & Community
Jan 2025 – Aug 2025
Designed an AI platform and community for career changers, working async with a global cross-functional team.

Reflect Android App
Aug 2025
Designed and built an AI journaling app solo in 7 days for the Bolt AI hackathon.

The Tricky B2B Onboarding
Article · Startup Stash (Medium) · May 2026